

STARTER

Field-by-Field Online Application Walkthrough

United Kingdom - Standard Visitor Visa

VERIFY BEFORE YOU APPLY

Fees, forms, and processing times change without notice. This guide reflects publicly documented procedures as commonly published; treat every dollar figure, form number, and timeline here as a starting point, and confirm the current version on the official government site before you submit anything or pay any fee.

Before you start

The Standard Visitor visa application is completed online at gov.uk (search “Standard Visitor visa”) - there is no separate downloadable paper form for most applicants. The online system is run by UK Visas and Immigration (UKVI), and your application is decided against Appendix V: Visitor of the Immigration Rules. Gather the following before you begin:

- Valid passport or other travel document
- Details of your trip: purpose, planned dates, and places you'll stay
- Your employment or study details, and your income
- Details of who is paying for the trip, and how
- Details of any family members who are UK or EU nationals, if applicable (different rules can apply)
- A digital photo, unless you're using the UK immigration “ID Check” smartphone app to verify your identity where your passport supports it (availability varies by country and passport type - check current eligibility on gov.uk)

YOUR APPLICATION REFERENCE NUMBER

Once you start, you're given a GWF reference number. Save it - you'll need it to pay the fee, book your biometric appointment, and track your application.

Section-by-section

1. Personal details

Name, date of birth, nationality, and passport details exactly as they appear in your passport. Declare any other nationalities or passports you hold.

2. Purpose and details of your visit

You'll select the reason for your visit (general tourism, visiting family/friends, business activities, medical treatment, and a number of other specific categories). Be accurate here - the category you choose is checked against the permitted activities for visitors, and picking the wrong one can misrepresent your actual plans.

- Give your planned entry and exit dates as accurately as you can
- List every UK address you'll stay at, even if some are hotels not yet booked
- If you'll also carry out permitted business activities (e.g. attending meetings, negotiating contracts, attending a conference) alongside tourism, say so - the visitor route does allow a defined list of business activities without amounting to "work"

3. Family and relationships

Details of your spouse/partner and children, and whether any of them are travelling with you or are already in the UK.

4. Employment, study, and finances

Your current job or course, your income, and how you'll fund the trip. This is where you start building the case that you can support yourself without working or relying on public funds, and that you'll leave the UK at the end of your visit.

5. Immigration history

Any previous UK visas, visits, refusals, overstays, or deportations - answer completely. Undisclosed history is one of the most damaging findings a caseworker can make, far more so than the underlying history itself would usually be.

6. Criminal and security declarations

Standard declarations covering criminal convictions, security concerns, and previous immigration breaches. Answer honestly - these are checked against records.

7. Pay the fee and book biometrics

After submitting, you pay the visa fee online (the fee varies by how long a visa you're applying for - 6 months, or the longer multi-entry options). You'll then book an appointment at a UK Visa Application Centre (UKVCAS, run by a contracted partner such as VFS Global in most countries) to give your fingerprints and photo ("biometric enrolment"), unless you're eligible to verify your identity via the ID Check app instead.

8. Upload supporting documents

You'll be given the option to upload supporting documents online, or bring them to your appointment, depending on the visa application centre's process in your country. Follow the specific instructions given after you book - they vary by location.